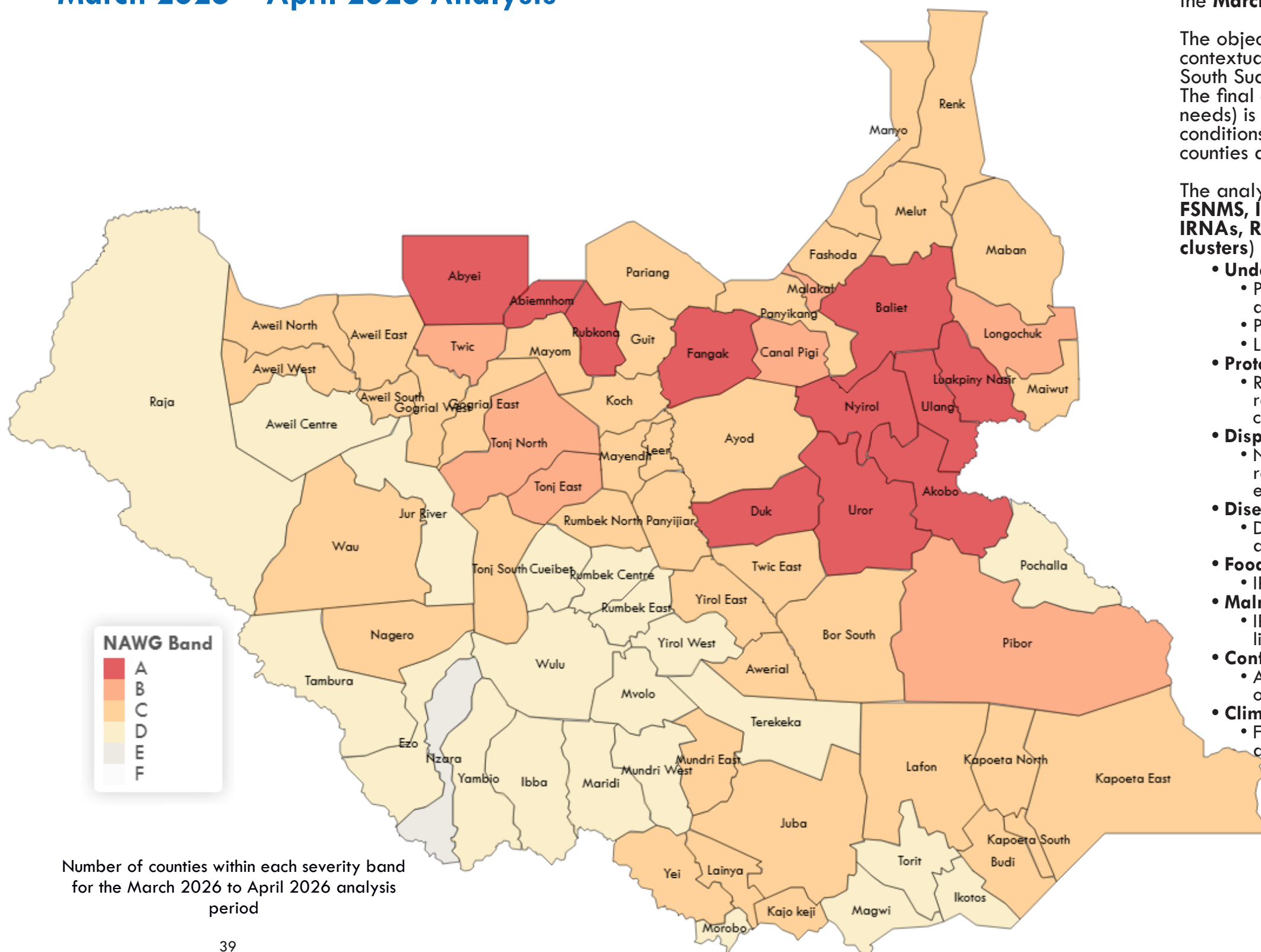


# SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

## March 2026 – April 2026 Analysis



Number of counties within each severity band for the March 2026 to April 2026 analysis period

### Background

The NAWG meeting was held on May 12, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **March 2026 to April 2026** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
  - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
  - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
  - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
  - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
  - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant number of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
  - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
  - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
  - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
  - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
  - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rainfall anomalies.

### Needs severity levels

| Severity band | Indicator threshold | Severity level definitions                         |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| A             | 8 - 10              | <b>Extreme</b> humanitarian conditions             |
| B             | 7 - 7.9             | <b>Very severe</b> humanitarian conditions         |
| C             | 6 - 6.9             | <b>Severe</b> humanitarian conditions              |
| D             | 4 - 5.9             | <b>Moderate</b> humanitarian conditions            |
| E             | 2 - 3.9             | <b>Stressed</b> humanitarian conditions            |
| F             | 0 - 1.9             | <b>Minor</b> or acceptable humanitarian conditions |

For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa ([sanjeewa@un.org](mailto:sanjeewa@un.org)) or Mary Langan ([mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org](mailto:mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org)).

# SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

## March 2026 – April 2026 Analysis

The **March – April 2026** NAWG analysis confirms a marked deterioration in the humanitarian picture across South Sudan. Band A (extreme humanitarian conditions) counties nearly doubled from **six to eleven** in the backend analysis; **26 counties shifted one band toward greater severity**, and only two improved (Mayom and Ayod, both B to C). IOM DTM tracked over **140,000 newly displaced individuals** across 21 counties, concentrated in Jonglei, the Abyei Administrative Area and Upper Nile. An estimated 200,000 people have been displaced from Akobo since February, with approximately 114,550 currently in Tiergol, Ethiopia, where they have no support from the host government or humanitarian agencies.

The updated IPC analysis (April – July 2026 projection period) is the dominant driver of this cycle's deterioration. An estimated **7.83 million people (55.2% of the population) are in IPC AFI Phase 3 or above**, including 2.49 million in Phase 4 and 73,305 in Phase 5 across six counties (Akobo, Fangak, Nyirol, Uror, Luakpiny/Nasir, Ulang).

According the IPC analysis, **four counties are at Risk of Famine: Akobo, Nyirol, Luakpiny/Nasir and Ulang**, with the period of greatest concern extending from June to September 2026. Eleven counties are now classified at IPC AMN Phase 5 (Akobo, Akoka, Ulang, Uror, Fangak, Abyei, Abiemnhom, Rubkona, Duk, Baliet, Luakpiny/Nasir), and cholera cases nationally exceeded 103,200 cumulative as of late April with a rising trend.

### Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Eleven counties were classified as having **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** during this analysis period. These counties are **Ulang, Luakpiny/Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, Abiemnhom, and Abyei**.

The deterioration in these counties is linked to conflict, displacement, and worsening food security and malnutrition rates.

### Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Canal/Pigi:** In early March, government forces conducted offensive operations across Atar, Diel and Korwai Payams, engaging in armed confrontations with opposition forces; a 6 March opposition counterattack in Awulian Village (Atar Payam) resulted in 20 fatalities. Seven conflict events and 27 fatalities were recorded by a conflict monitoring partner; 8,427 individuals were reportedly newly displaced. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**

- **Malakal:** On 23 April, a humanitarian-contracted driver was assaulted at a security checkpoint by uniformed personnel. On 22 March, youth from unspecified communities clashed at the Protection of Civilians site; intercommunal clashes were reported on 16 April. The security environment remains volatile. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Longochuk:** Flagged due to persistent access constraints and active conflict. On 25 April, a planned humanitarian convoy of 30 commercial trucks carrying food assistance was suspended after local authorities and security entities demanded excessive and unauthorised payments. Government airstrikes targeted suspected opposition positions in Udier and Chotbora Payams in late March. A 10 May letter from local authorities to humanitarian partners reports that 7,276 people (1,421 households) have been displaced to Udier Payam following renewed conflict in four other opposition-controlled payams of Longochuk. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Tonj East:** Flagged due to severe intercommunal violence. On 25 April, intercommunal clashes between cattle-keeping communities in Makier (Wunlit Payam) reportedly left 50 people dead and many injured or missing. Ten conflict events and 73 fatalities were recorded, the third highest nationally. The acting Governor ordered deployment of security forces to the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Tonj North:** Elevated from Band C to Band B at the meeting on the basis of low humanitarian footprint, restricted movement from Kuajok linked to communal violence, and the chronic nature of the underlying drivers. Six conflict events and 61 fatalities were recorded, driven by the 16 March Aliek Payam cattle camp raid, a 20 April attack by armed youth from neighbouring Gogrial East in Kirik Payam, and a 26 April clash between youths from Marial Lou and Akop Payams. **Final classification: Elevated to Band B.**
- **Panyikang:** Flaged due to significant conflict during April. On 19 April, opposition forces and armed youth attacked and overran government positions in Wunkur (Tonga Payam); government forces counterattacked the following day. Five conflict events and 10 fatalities were recorded; 3,662 individuals were newly displaced. The escalation raised concerns about spillover toward neighbouring Canal/Pigi and Fangak. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Mayom:** Flagged due persisting intercommunal violence. Nine conflict events and 25 fatalities were recorded by a conflict monitoring partner, including intracommunal clashes, cross-border cattle raids, and a government airstrike in Kueryiek Payam on 17 March following a cattle raid. Cross-state cattle raids between communities in Unity and Warrap remain a persistent driver. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

- **Kapoeta East:** Cross-border cattle raids from Kenya and clashes with armed youth from a neighbouring community were recorded during the period. On 11 April at approximately 05:15 in Mogos Payam, armed youth attacked the police station with fighting concentrated around the Commissioner's premises, the County Headquarters and the police station; the incident reportedly resulted in four fatalities and three injuries. IPC AMN worsened from Phase 3 to Phase 4 in the latest update. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Mundri East:** Flagged due to intercommunal violence between cattle-herding and farming communities. On 14 March, herders attacked members of a farming community in Minga Payam, reportedly leaving at least 17 dead and displacing more than 3,000 civilians. Eleven conflict events and 22 fatalities were recorded; 8,320 individuals were reportedly newly displaced, the sixth highest nationally. Several humanitarian shelter responses were reported by partners. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

### Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information. All 11 Band A counties remain under close monitoring by default (**Ulang, Luakpiny/Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, Abiemnhom, and Abyei**).

**Additional close monitoring** is recommended for counties where worsening severity, displacement, conflict dynamics or response gaps require continued attention. **Wau, Yei and Lainya** moved from Band D to Band C following increased conflict activity, civilian harm, displacement and, in **Lainya**, worsening acute malnutrition. **Gogrial East** remains Band C, with needs driven by cross-state cattle raids, clashes involving armed groups and continued insecurity in affected payams.

**Ayod** dropped from Band B to Band C due to a lower conflict score, though severe food security, nutrition and displacement needs persist, with some assistance now underway. **Pibor** remains Band B and is flagged due to displacement and continued cattle-raiding and age-set tensions, while **Twic** moved from Band C to Band B as displacement-related needs continue to rise and shelter response activities continue. **Aweil East** remains flagged due to the ongoing Sudan refugee response. **Nagero and Mundri West** are also flagged despite a Band D classification, reflecting significant displacement, protection concerns, limited market and service access, health and WASH risks, and limited partner presence or response gaps.